Are they making older drivers retest?

Not more

The two states in the headlines made renewal easier.

> "Starting July 1, the new law raises the age at which Illinois drivers must take a driving test from 79 to 87, removing an outdated age-based requirement that made Illinois the only state in the nation to require a behind-the-wheel test solely because of a driver's age."
>
> "The California Department of Motor Vehicles (DMV) today announced that drivers 70-years-old and older in California whose licenses expire in 2024 and beyond will no longer be required to take a written knowledge test beginning October 1."
>
> **Illinois Secretary of State, 17 June 2026 · California DMV, 30 September 2024**

ILLINOIS NOW	79–80 every 4 years; 81–86 every 2; 87+ every year with a road test. In person, with a vision test. Expired before July 1, 2026? Still a road test at 79–86. Drivers 75+ crash "lower than every age group between 16 and 74."
CALIFORNIA NOW	At 70+, still "an office visit" for a vision exam and photo, every five years. Some still test: two or more accidents in two years, a DUI suspension, and similar.
NOTE	Illinois pages disagree on some intervals: confirm with the Secretary of State.

YOURS

My license expires on: _____

Checked 3 Nov 2026 at: ilsos.gov/news/2026/june-17-2026-giannoulias-ends-mandatory-road-tests-for-drivers-ages-79-86.html · dmv.ca.gov/portal/news-and-media/news-releases/ · dmv.ca.gov/portal/senior-drivers/

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